TASK 5

PART -A

Phishing is a type of cybercrime where attackers trick individuals into revealing sensitive information such as passwords, bank details, or OTPs by pretending to be a trusted source. A common scenario involves a student receiving an email or message that appears to be from a bank or a popular online service. The message usually creates urgency, such as claiming that the account will be blocked unless immediate action is taken.

The attack typically happens in several steps. First, the victim receives a fake email or SMS with a link. Second, the link directs them to a fraudulent website that closely resembles a legitimate one. Third, the user enters their login credentials or financial details. Finally, the attacker captures this information and uses it for unauthorized transactions or identity theft.

Students and young individuals are often targeted because they frequently use online platforms and may not always verify sources carefully. The consequences can include financial loss, compromised accounts, and misuse of personal data. In some cases, victims may also lose access to their social media or academic accounts.

This case highlights the importance of being cautious while interacting with unknown links and verifying the authenticity

of digital communication before sharing any personal information.

PART -B

Stay Safe Online Checklist

General Safety Tips

- Use **strong and unique passwords** for different accounts
- Enable **two-factor authentication (2FA)** wherever possible
- Avoid clicking on **unknown or suspicious links**
- Always check if a website uses **https** before entering data
- Do not share personal information on public platforms
- Keep your apps and devices **updated regularly**

Financial / UPI Safety

- Never share your **OTP, PIN, or UPI credentials** with anyone
- Verify payment requests before accepting them on apps like Google Pay or PhonePe

Reporting Cybercrime

- Report incidents at **National Cyber Crime Portal:** https://cybercrime.gov.in
- Call **Helpline: 1930**

PART C

REFLECTION

While researching phishing attacks, I was surprised by how realistic and convincing fake messages and websites can be. Many phishing attempts closely mimic trusted platforms, making it difficult even for careful users to identify them at first glance. I realized that even a small mistake, such as clicking on an unknown link, can lead to serious consequences like financial loss or data theft.

One habit I plan to change is being more cautious before clicking on any links or responding to urgent messages. I will make it a practice to verify the source of emails and messages, especially those asking for personal or financial information. This task has made me more aware of online threats and the importance of following safe digital practices in everyday life.